1.4.4 Auditable actions for provenance

In health care and other operations, such as disaster recovery, there's often a question of whether actions and interventions were undertaken at the appropriate time. You must have heard of cases in which a diagnostic test ordered at the right time would have prevented the untimely demise of a patient. In one particular case narrated by an expert in the field, the doctor did order the test, but the order was canceled by somebody else. This case ended up in a court of law. The doctor had to prove his side of the story--something that would have been helped by having the sequence of orders recorded in a distributed ledger. In this case, smart contracts could have been used for provenance, indicating that a particular treatment was ordered at the right time by a doctor.

The distributed ledger created by the smart contract can provide ready access to the audit trail of the actions taken for provenance in many other situations. I'm sure you can think of examples in your own organization in which important undertakings could be proved by an audit trail stored within the stakeholders' blockchain infrastructure.

1.4.5 Guidance for governance

Let's look at another use case from the health care domain. You must be aware of the rampant misuse of opioids in the United States and its disastrous consequences. Smart